

AN ELECTRIFYING WAR



THE BATTLEFIELD

► **The dominance of first movers**
Tata Motors and JSW MG Motor India is at risk as other legacy players Maruti Suzuki India, M&M and Hyundai prepare to launch EV models in India beginning January next year



COMPLETE EV ECOSYSTEM

► **Maruti Suzuki India, the country's largest automaker, is poised to launch its first EV next year while concentrating on addressing customer concerns and developing the complete EV ecosystem**



TECH FORCE

► **M&M's partnership with Škoda Auto Volkswagen India for EV components and technology will provide it with a competitive edge in technology and exports**



BATTERY POWER

► **JSW MG Motor India is focussed on introducing new energy vehicles, primarily EVs, to the Indian market with its Battery-as-a-Service (BaaS) model**



FIRST & FOREMOST

► **Tata Motors is leaving no stone unturned to maintain its market position by bringing price parity between new EV models across all price segments and pulling synergies inside the Tata group**

Chandra, who is leading Tata Motors's electrification journey, says that the company has been proactively passing to customers all benefits accruing from reducing battery prices as well as localisation. Recently, the company reduced the price of the Nexon.ev by up to ₹3 lakh and that of Punch.ev by up to ₹1.5 lakh.

Moreover, all vehicle manufacturers will need to comply with tighter and stricter emission norms going forward. "Costs of ICE vehicles rise with every new regulation aimed at reducing emissions. The advent of the next level of Bharat Stage Emission Standards and corporate average fuel economy (CAFE) norms will increase the cost of conventional, ICE vehicles," says Chandra, who is also President of the Society of the Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM).

Chandra says giving price parity on a low-range EV is impractical. "I measure the price parity between EV and ICE of a product in any segment only when the EV can deliver 350-400 km range on a single charge. Then it becomes convenient and practical for customers as they can freely use the vehicle for both intercity and intracity drives," says Chandra.

Tata Motors, which recently launched electric variants of its mid-size SUV Curvv, offers larger battery packs of 45 kWh (range 502 km) and 35 kWh (430 km). The Curvv variants, priced at ₹17.49-21.99 lakh, are almost at par with several mid-size ICE models, such as the Maruti Suzuki Grand Vitara, Hyundai Creta, Mahindra Thar, and Mahindra XUV700.

JSW MG Motor India aims to bring price parity through its unique Battery-as-a-Service (BaaS) model which will lower the upfront cost of EVs. It has roped in Bajaj Finance, Hero FinCorp, Ecofy and Vidyut Tech, all non-banking finance companies that offer loans. JSW MG Motor will use telematics to track the kilometres driven.

Bajaj Finance could charge customers ₹3.5 per km for a fixed usage of 1,500 km a month for the batteries it finances, irrespective of how much the customer drives. So, the EV owner will pay ₹5,250 a month to own the battery. Hero FinCorp will offer the same rates but charge extra for extra kilometres. Ecofy and Autovert will aim their offerings at people with low credit scores, charging ₹5.8 for a minimum running of 1,500 km. No extras for extra kilometres, so the customer will have to pay ₹8,780 a month to own the battery. Vidyut Tech is offering the simplest scheme: its customers must pay ₹2.5 a km.

JSW MG's Chaba says the company has extended BaaS to its existing EV lineup, the ZS EV and MG Comet EV. "Thanks to the BaaS option, Comet is now coming at a pricing of less than ₹5 lakh," says Chaba, adding that